than aiming to transform significantly. We also think that the more mature you are in this model, the more value you will be able to extract from moving into a data mesh.

KEY POINT A data mesh is for companies with a certain level of data maturity.

Software engineering maturity (CI/CD, DevOps)

A data mesh is a socio-technical change in company operations. As much as we emphasize the sociological part of the transformation, the technological part needs to be on par with it. To evaluate whether your software development teams will be able to efficiently introduce the necessary changes, you will need to consider their engineering maturity.

The following list is not comprehensive. However, for a good overview of the general state of the teams that will carry the brunt of the transformation, you should be considering the following:

- Level of test automation
- Development operations (DevOps) culture
- Continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD)
- Level of embedding security factors into the development process
- Focus on developing products instead of projects

If these concepts are not the bread and butter for your development teams, implementing good data products will be difficult for them. It could be advisable to focus on improving your engineering maturity before beginning a data mesh transformation.

KEY POINT A data mesh is for companies with a high level of software engineering maturity.

You need to consider a few more organizational-related drivers when deciding whether a data mesh is right for your company. We present them separately in section 2.1.4 because their weight is much lower than the drivers presented in this and the following sections. Figure 2.1 depicts the summary of main organizational data mesh drivers.